

ISHWARYA SURESH

UX Consultant

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

UX Consultant offering product and interaction design, strategy and discovery, and accessibility-led delivery for clients across public sector, healthcare, education, architecture, and startups. Founder of an independent UX practice delivering end-to-end product design, research-driven discovery, and WCAG-compliant accessibility from the first wireframe. Track record of measurable impact: improved engagement and course-completion rates, hardened accessibility for 50+ Local Authorities, and de-risked product roadmaps.

CORE SKILLS

UX Design: Wireframing, Prototyping, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, High-Fidelity UI, Design Systems, Design Tokens, Component Libraries, Responsive Design, Mobile and Web Design

Service Design: Service Blueprints, User Journey Mapping, Cross-Channel Experience Design, Stakeholder Mapping, Workshop Facilitation, Inclusive Design, Government Design System (GDS) Standards

Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA, WCAG 2.2, Colour and Contrast, Keyboard and Focus States, Screen-Reader Testing, Cognitive Load, Content Design

User Research: Interviews, Usability Testing, Ethnographic Studies, Co-Design Workshops, Focus Groups, Diary Studies, Surveys, A/B Testing, Card Sorting, Tree Testing, Heatmaps

Synthesis & Strategy: Thematic Analysis, Affinity Mapping, Persona Development, Opportunity Mapping, North-Star Metrics, Data-Informed Roadmap Prioritisation

Tools: Figma, Sketch, Framer, InVision, Principle, Miro, Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, Dovetail, Hotjar, Tableau

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & UX Consultant | MadeForHumans

May 2025 to Present | Full-Time | Remote

- Founded an independent UX consultancy delivering product and interaction design, strategy and discovery, and accessibility services to startups, studios, and SMEs.
- Lead end-to-end product and interaction design, taking engagements from kickoff through discovery, user flows, wireframes, high-fidelity UI in Figma, and developer handover.
- Run discovery and strategy through stakeholder and user interviews, usability tests, opportunity mapping, and north-star metrics; synthesise in Dovetail.
- Embed WCAG 2.2 accessibility into the first wireframe, covering colour and contrast, keyboard and focus, screen-reader behaviour, and cognitive load.
- Delivered an architecture studio website in Framer, producing research-driven IA, case-study templates, and user flows from stakeholder interviews.

User Researcher | Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government

July 2024 – April 2025 | Full-Time | Newcastle upon Tyne, UK (Hybrid)

- Led UX strategy for government grants services to Government Design System (GDS) standards, improving usability and achieving WCAG 2.1 AA compliance for over 50 Local Authorities.
- Planned and ran surveys, semi-structured interviews, and moderated usability testing; analysed findings through thematic and affinity mapping.

- Maintained ResearchOps and governance practices, ensuring research quality, ethical standards, and reusable insight repositories.
- Presented insights and service design recommendations to senior stakeholders, influencing product roadmaps with data-informed decisions.
- Worked within an agile team of service designers, product managers, and developers to integrate user insights into delivery.

UX Consultant | Freelance (Self-Employed)

September 2023 to April 2025 | Remote

- Delivered end-to-end product and interaction design for clients across healthcare, education, and tech, embedding with founder and product teams.
- Led discovery through stakeholder interviews, competitive analysis, and user research; produced opportunity maps and roadmaps.
- Led design for a healthcare mobile app; mapped IA and simplified navigation in Figma, increasing engagement by 15%.
- Redesigned a remote-learning platform; prototyped interactive flows and refined content design, increasing course completion by 20%.
- Embedded WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility into early design: contrast, keyboard and focus, screen-reader, and cognitive load.

UX Designer / Researcher | Novacroft

August 2023 – September 2023 | United Kingdom (Remote)

- Led UX for the Transport for London (TfL) Care Leaver Oyster Card campaign, applying inclusive design to increase accessibility and adoption.
- Ran a full research and design cycle: persona development, journey mapping, and prototyping in InVision.
- Partnered with stakeholders to validate design solutions and worked with development teams on implementation.

User Research Intern | Nebula Labs

February 2023 – April 2023 | Newcastle upon Tyne, UK

- Led a research project for the Me & You digital app to enhance quality of life for people living with dementia.
- Synthesised interviews, field studies, and co-design workshops into actionable design strategies for patients and carers.
- Collaborated with academics from Newcastle and Northumbria Universities, validating insights through focus groups.

UX Designer | Freelance (Self-Employed)

April 2021 – February 2023 | Part-Time | Newcastle upon Tyne, UK

- Delivered freelance UX design and research for clients across multiple sectors alongside postgraduate studies.
- Produced wireframes, prototypes, and visual designs in Figma and Sketch tailored to client brand and user needs.
- Conducted user research, usability testing, and competitive analysis to inform user-centred designs.

UX/UI Design Intern | AnywhereWorks / FULL Creative

January 2021 – March 2021 | Chennai, India

- Redesigned the AnywhereWorks platform UI, contributing to an increase in user retention rates.
- Built and maintained a design system and style guide, improving brand consistency and reducing development time.
- Simplified onboarding workflows for the Switchboard app, leading to higher user activation rates.

EDUCATION

MSc Human Computer Interaction | Newcastle University | 2021 – 2022 | Newcastle upon Tyne, UK

- Specialised in Interaction Design, UX Research Methods, and Prototyping.
- Dissertation: Co-designed and evaluated an ambient air quality sensing technology for workplace well-being, in collaboration with a PhD researcher.
- Dissertation work acknowledged in a paper accepted at the ACM CHI 2024 Conference.

Bachelor of Architecture (B.Arch) | Anna University | 2015 – 2020 | Chennai, India

- Built a strong foundation in design thinking, sustainable design, and systems-level problem-solving.